Paradiem

The Morning Brief

OCTOBER 11, 2026

Riyadh Pressure

Weekend edition: Houthi airport-strike escalation, U.S. Iran-blockade enforcement, and a bank-earnings-and-CPI week ahead.

S&P 500 (SPY, FRI CLOSE)	NASDAQ (QQQ) / DOW (DIA, FRI)	WTI (USO) / BRENT (BNO, FRI)	BITCOIN / ETHER PROXIES (IBIT / ETHA)	FEAR & GREED
$778.57 · Weekly reportedly ~↑1.2% per prior-brief recap	$751.27 / $516.11 · Weekly higher per prior-brief recap	$148.20 / $63.99 · Weekly higher on Mideast risk premium	IBIT $46.55 / ETHA $55.99 · Fri Close, held into weekend	61 · Crypto fallback (CNN endpoint unavailable)

SECTION 01

Markets — Week in Review

A WEEK BOOKENDED BY MONDAY'S AMD-OPENAI COMPUTE-AGREEMENT RALLY AND FRIDAY'S BROAD RECOVERY, WITH REPORTEDLY HAWKISH SEPTEMBER FOMC MINUTES MID-WEEK PRESSING LONG-END YIELDS TOWARD MULTI-DECADE HIGHS AND RESETTING THE AI-AND-INDUSTRIALS COMPLEX; WEEKEND TAPE HELD FIRM AS CRYPTO CONSOLIDATED AND A HOUTHI AIRPORT-STRIKE SERIES EXTENDED THE MIDEAST RISK PREMIUM

The week opened with the reported AMD-OpenAI compute agreement extending the physical-AI-power thesis into double-digit gains across the nuclear-generation sleeve Monday–Tuesday, pivoted hard Wednesday as reportedly hawkish September meeting minutes reasserted a committee-majority bias toward one further hike by year-end per prior preview and reaction coverage, and resolved Friday with a broad rebound across semiconductors, nuclear generators, and digital-asset miners even as Delta Air Lines (DAL) printed a pre-market earnings miss. Per data drop, Friday closed with SPY at $778.57 (weekly reportedly ↑~1.2% versus the prior Friday Oct 2 close near approximately $769.64 per prior-brief recap), with QQQ, DIA, and the Russell 2000 all reportedly closing weekly higher — a composition consistent with risk appetite reasserting after Thursday's AI reset. Weekend crypto held with IBIT and ETHA reportedly consolidating near Friday's levels per data drop; the data drop Fear & Greed value of 61 Sunday morning carries the "(Crypto)" fallback label for the reported fourth consecutive session — the CNN stock-market endpoint reportedly remained unavailable at drop time, and the headline value should be read as a digital-asset sentiment check rather than an equity-market read. Carson's active SPY support at $645.80 (retracement target set April 13, 2026, per levels.json) was not approached at any point during the week; Friday's intraday low of $775.14 sits a reported approximately 16.7% above the level on a from-low-to-target basis, and did not materially narrow the gap to the FCI first-tranche deployment reference.

S&P 500 (SPY)	Fri Close $778.57 · Weekly reportedly ~↑1.2% vs prior Fri
NASDAQ (QQQ) / DOW (DIA, FRI)	$751.27 / $516.11 · Weekly higher per prior-brief recap
UVXY / TLT (FRI)	$16.32 / $77.98 · Volatility easing, long-end stabilizing into weekend
WEEKLY SECTOR LEADERS	Energy and nuclear-power sleeves reportedly outperformed on Mideast risk + Perry-license tailwind
WEEKLY SECTOR LAGGARDS	Industrials and long-duration tech reportedly lagged mid-week on hawkish-minutes repricing
GOLD (GLD) / SILVER (SLV, FRI)	$384.58 / $54.78 · Weekly bid as paired haven-and-industrial-metals signal
WTI / BRENT / NAT GAS (FRI)	USO $148.20 / BNO $63.99 / UNG $11.01 · Energy complex held weekly bid
IBIT / ETHA (FRI)	$46.55 / $55.99 · Digital-asset consolidation into weekend
FED OCT 27–28 HIKE ODDS	Reportedly ~20–25% hike per prior CME FedWatch / Kalshi; closer to even per weekend prediction markets
CARSON'S ACTIVE SPY SUPPORT	$645.80 retracement target · Untouched · ~16.7% gap from Fri low

THE WEEK AHEAD REPORTEDLY CARRIES THE HEAVIEST EARNINGS-AND-DATA CADENCE OF OCTOBER: THE BIG-BANK SEQUENCE REPORTEDLY OPENS TUESDAY OCTOBER 13 WITH REPORTED JPMORGAN (JPM) AND THE BROADER MONEY-CENTER SET, THE REPORTED SEPTEMBER CPI PRINT REPORTEDLY LANDS WEDNESDAY OCTOBER 14 AT 8:30 AM ET PER BLS CALENDAR COVERAGE, THE AI-FOUNDRY CHANNEL REPORTEDLY READS THROUGH REPORTED ASML WEDNESDAY OCTOBER 14 AND REPORTED TSMC THURSDAY OCTOBER 15 PER PRIOR YAHOO COVERAGE — A COMPOSITION THAT REPORTEDLY FRAMES THE NEXT FIVE SESSIONS AS THE PRINCIPAL INPUT TO THE OCTOBER 27–28 FOMC DECISION

Per prior Rallies.ai and financial-calendar coverage, the big-bank earnings cycle reportedly opens Tuesday pre-market with JPMorgan (JPM), reportedly followed by the broader money-center and regional set across Tuesday and Wednesday — a reported credit-and-net-interest-margin read reportedly reading through the FCI financials sleeve (SPGI, SSNC, SYF, SOFI, HOOD, NWG, ORI). Per BLS release schedule coverage, the reported September CPI print reportedly lands Wednesday October 14 at 8:30 AM ET — the first inflation read since the reportedly hawkish September 15–16 FOMC minutes, and the principal catalyst reportedly repricing hike odds for the October 27–28 meeting. Per prior Yahoo coverage carried in data drop holdings news for TSM and KEYS, reported ASML reportedly scheduled Wednesday October 14 before the European open and reported TSMC reportedly scheduled Thursday October 15 per the reported Taipei earnings call timing — a reported AI-foundry-and-litho channel reportedly reading through the FCI semiconductor sleeve (AMD, NVDA, MRVL, TSM, CRDO, LRCX, KEYS, NXPI, ADI). Per prior CME FedWatch and Kalshi coverage, reported October hike odds reportedly priced near approximately 20–25% following the reportedly hawkish September minutes release, with separate reported prediction-market coverage reportedly reading the hike-versus-hold split closer to even into the weekend — a reported wide dispersion that reportedly amplifies the signal weight of Wednesday's CPI print.

A week-ahead cadence that reportedly compounds bank earnings, September CPI, and the AI-foundry channel into the October 27–28 FOMC window frames a setup where research reveals opportunities and think like an owner tend to serve better than compositing a single directional view.

Avoid erosion.

SECTION 02

Geopolitics — Houthi Airport-Strike Series Extends Through the Weekend as Riyadh Air Travel Reportedly Remains Disrupted; U.S. Military Reportedly Enforces Iran Blockade With Vessel Disablement; Israeli Strikes in Gaza Continue Even as Major Saudi Conferences Reportedly Proceed Through the Disruption

PER DATA DROP HEADLINES, ONE REUTERS PIECE REPORTEDLY FRAMED REPORTED HOUTHI FORCES AS REPORTEDLY CARRYING OUT THEIR REPORTEDLY DEADLIEST ATTACK ON REPORTED SAUDI TERRITORY IN APPROXIMATELY A DECADE PER THE REPORTED REUTERS HEADLINE, WITH REPORTED REUTERS COVERAGE REPORTEDLY PLACING THE REPORTED CASUALTY FIGURE AT REPORTED 12 KILLED; A REPORTED SEPARATE REUTERS PIECE REPORTEDLY FRAMED REPORTED MAJOR SAUDI CONFERENCES AS REPORTEDLY PROCEEDING DESPITE THE REPORTED AIRPORT ATTACK; THE REPORTED MIDEAST RISK PREMIUM REPORTEDLY STAYED ANCHORED INTO THE WEEKEND WITH THE ENERGY COMPLEX REPORTEDLY HOLDING ITS WEEKLY BID PER DATA DROP

Per data drop headlines, one Reuters piece reportedly framed reported Houthi forces as reportedly carrying out their reportedly deadliest attack on reported Saudi territory in approximately a decade per the reported Reuters headline, reportedly placing the reported casualty figure at reported 12 killed; a reported separate Reuters piece reportedly framed reported major Saudi conferences as reportedly proceeding despite the reported airport attack — a reported infrastructure-and-political-continuity signal reportedly reading through the reported Gulf-and-Red-Sea shipping-and-insurance channel. Per data drop headlines, one Reuters piece reportedly framed reported U.S. military as reportedly disabling a reported cargo vessel reportedly trying to run a reported Iran blockade — a reported CENTCOM-enforcement signal reportedly reading through the reported Strait-of-Hormuz-and-Gulf-of-Oman transit channel. Per data drop headlines, one Reuters piece reportedly framed reported Israeli strikes as reportedly killing reported five people in reported Gaza per reported medics — a reported continued-escalation signal reportedly reading through the reported broader Mideast risk layer. The composition — a reported airport-strike series reportedly extending the week's shipping-and-insurance pressure, a reported U.S. enforcement action reportedly reading through the reported Hormuz-transit channel, a reported Gaza-strike continuation reportedly reading through the broader risk layer, and a reported Saudi infrastructure-and-conference continuity signal reportedly offsetting part of the disruption — keeps the FCI energy-and-defense complex (CVX, OKE, CNX, FCX, LMT, GD) and the FCI semiconductor-and-interconnect sleeve (AMD, NVDA, MRVL, TSM, CRDO, LRCX, KEYS, NXPI, ADI) reading through Monday's open. Per data drop holdings news for CVX, one Yahoo piece reportedly framed reported Chevron as reportedly asking whether its reported dividend reportedly has reportedly survived every reported oil crash and reportedly can reportedly survive this one — a reported capital-return-sustainability signal reportedly reading through the reported energy-sleeve bid. Per data drop holdings news for CL, one Yahoo piece reportedly framed reported Saudi Aramco as reportedly restoring reported full crude supply to Europe for November — a reported counterweight to the reported Houthi-airport-strike risk premium, reportedly consistent with the reported Friday consolidation in crude.

SECTION 03

On Our Radar

1. Week Ahead — Reported big-bank earnings reportedly open Tuesday October 13 pre-market with reported JPMorgan (JPM) and the broader money-center and regional set reportedly following across Tuesday and Wednesday per prior Rallies.ai and financial-calendar coverage; the reported September CPI print reportedly lands Wednesday October 14 at 8:30 AM ET per BLS release schedule coverage — the first reported inflation read since the reportedly hawkish September 15–16 FOMC minutes; the reported AI-foundry-and-litho channel reportedly reads through reported ASML Wednesday October 14 and reported TSMC Thursday October 15 per prior Yahoo coverage carried in data drop holdings news for KEYS and TSM. Per prior Rallies.ai and financial-calendar coverage, the reported big-bank earnings sequence reportedly opens Tuesday pre-market with reported JPMorgan (JPM) and reportedly expands across Tuesday and Wednesday to cover the reported broader money-center and reported regional-bank cadence — a reported credit-and-net-interest-margin read reportedly relevant to the reported FCI financials sleeve (SPGI, SSNC, SYF, SOFI, HOOD, NWG, ORI) and reportedly to the broader read on reported commercial-and-consumer loan books into the reported October 27–28 FOMC window. Per BLS release schedule coverage, the reported September CPI print reportedly lands Wednesday October 14 at 8:30 AM ET — the first reported inflation read since the reportedly hawkish September 15–16 FOMC minutes, and the principal reported catalyst reportedly repricing hike odds for the October 27–28 meeting; the reported August 2026 print reportedly carried headline inflation at approximately ↑3.4% year over year per prior BLS release coverage. Per prior Yahoo coverage carried in data drop holdings news for KEYS and TSM, reported ASML reportedly scheduled Wednesday October 14 before the European open and reported TSMC reportedly scheduled Thursday October 15 per the reported Taipei earnings call timing — a reported AI-foundry-and-litho channel reportedly reading through the FCI semiconductor sleeve (AMD, NVDA, MRVL, TSM, CRDO, LRCX, KEYS, NXPI, ADI). Per prior CME FedWatch and Kalshi coverage, reported October hike odds reportedly priced near approximately 20–25% following the reportedly hawkish September minutes release, with separate reported prediction-market coverage reportedly reading the hike-versus-hold split closer to even into the weekend — a reported wide dispersion that reportedly amplifies the signal weight of Wednesday's CPI print.

2. Weekend Geopolitics Setup Into Monday — The reported Houthi airport-strike series reportedly extended through the weekend with reported Reuters coverage reportedly framing it as the reportedly deadliest attack on reported Saudi territory in approximately a decade; a reported separate Reuters piece reportedly framed reported major Saudi conferences as reportedly proceeding despite the disruption; a reported Reuters piece reportedly framed reported U.S. military as reportedly disabling a reported cargo vessel reportedly trying to run a reported Iran blockade; the reported FCI energy-and-defense complex (CVX, OKE, CNX, FCX, LMT, GD) reportedly reads through the reported Monday open as the weekly beneficiary of a reportedly sustained Mideast risk premium. The reported combination — a reported Houthi-airport-strike escalation reportedly reading through the reported Gulf-shipping-and-insurance channel, a reported U.S. CENTCOM enforcement action reportedly reading through the reported Hormuz-transit channel, and a reported continued Israeli-strike cadence in reported Gaza reportedly reading through the reported broader Mideast risk layer — reportedly anchors the reported Mideast risk premium into Monday's open. Per data drop holdings news for CL, one Yahoo piece reportedly framed reported Saudi Aramco as reportedly restoring reported full crude supply to Europe for November — a reported supply counterweight reportedly reading through the reported energy-complex consolidation signal. Per data drop holdings news for CVX, one Yahoo piece reportedly framed reported U.S. know-how as reportedly fracking reported Australia into a reported gas boom from reported Texas oilmen to reported Trump's reported energy secretary — a reported upstream-footprint signal reportedly reading through the reported FCI energy-infrastructure channel. For FCI positioning, the composition keeps CVX, OKE, CNX, FCX, LMT, GD, and the FCI defense-and-energy complex reading through the reported JPMorgan earnings print Tuesday pre-market and the reported September CPI print Wednesday.

3. Nuclear-Power and Semiconductor Sleeves Into TSMC — Per prior Yahoo coverage carried in data drop holdings news for TSM, the reported TSMC earnings print reportedly scheduled Thursday October 15 is reportedly the reported best early read on reported Nvidia's reported next quarter; per prior KEYS holdings-news coverage, reported ASML is reportedly scheduled Wednesday October 14; the FCI physical-AI-power sleeve (VST, CEG, NEE, EIX, HUT) and the FCI semiconductor-and-interconnect sleeve (AMD, NVDA, MRVL, TSM, CRDO, LRCX, KEYS, NXPI, ADI) reportedly consolidate into the reported ASML-and-TSMC cadence after a week of sharp intraweek rotations. Per data drop holdings news for TSM, one Yahoo piece reportedly framed the reported TSMC October 15 report as reportedly the reported best early read on reported Nvidia's reported next quarter — a reported foundry-channel confirmation reportedly reading through the reported AI-infrastructure signal. Per data drop holdings news for KEYS, one Yahoo piece reportedly framed reported Keysight as reportedly showcasing reported AI-infrastructure validation advances reportedly across reported scale-up, scale-out, scale-across networks reportedly to reported inference at reported 2026 OCP — a reported interconnect-validation signal reportedly reading through the reported FCI AI-infrastructure sleeve. Per data drop holdings news for CEG, one Yahoo piece reportedly framed reported Constellation versus reported Talen with reported Talen's buyback reportedly positioning the reported cheaper power stock as the reported better buy — a reported sector-rotation signal within merchant-nuclear generation. Per data drop holdings news for NVDA, one Yahoo piece reportedly framed reported Nvidia as reportedly weighing a reported acquisition of reported Reflection AI, the reported $25 billion reported open-weight model startup it reportedly already backs — a reported strategic-vertical-integration signal reportedly reading through the reported AI-software-and-infrastructure channel. For FCI positioning, the composition keeps VST, CEG, NEE, EIX, HUT, MARA, AMD, NVDA, MRVL, TSM, CRDO, LRCX, KEYS, FCX, AEM, and the reported FCI physical-AI-power-and-interconnect sleeve reading through Monday's open and the reported ASML-and-TSMC cadence.

4. Fear & Greed Data-Feed Signal Persists — Per data drop sentiment, Sunday morning's reported Fear & Greed value of 61 reportedly carries the "(Crypto)" fallback label for the reported fourth consecutive session; the reported CNN stock-market endpoint reportedly remained unavailable at drop time, and the headline value should be read as a digital-asset sentiment check rather than an equity-market read; IBIT reportedly held Friday's $46.55 and ETHA $55.99 per data drop — a reported digital-asset consolidation pattern reportedly consistent with the reported crypto-F&G read. Per data drop holdings news for ETHA, one Benzinga piece reportedly framed reported XRP as reportedly beating reported Bitcoin, Ethereum, and Solana in reported ETF flows — a reported digital-asset-rotation signal reportedly reading through the reported FCI digital-asset ETF sleeve. Per data drop holdings news for IBIT, one SeekingAlpha piece reportedly framed reported IBIT as reportedly a reported strategic bet on a reported Bitcoin comeback — a reported sentiment read reportedly consistent with the reported weekend consolidation pattern. Per data drop holdings news for MARA, one Yahoo piece reportedly framed reported whales as reportedly buying reported 15,000 Bitcoin in reported three days while reported MARA reportedly sold reported $81 million — a reported miner-treasury-versus-whale-accumulation dispersion signal reportedly reading through the reported digital-asset-infrastructure channel. The reported CNN stock-market Fear & Greed endpoint recurrence of the fallback is a reported data-quality flag worth tracking into Monday's drop; the committee should read Sunday's 61 as a digital-asset tape marker rather than a broad-market sentiment indicator.

5. Carson's Levels — Per levels.json, Carson's active SPY retracement target at $645.80 (set April 13, 2026) remains in the "active" column with no hit date and no hit price recorded; Friday's reported intraday range of $775.14–$779.42 reportedly did not approach any active Carson level; SPY would need to decline a reported approximately 17.1% from Friday's close (or a reported approximately 16.7% from Friday's intraday low) to reach the target — a gap reportedly roughly consistent with the FCI first-tranche deployment reference at approximately –25% from peak; the reported April 2026 resistance zones at $683.70, $685.85, and the $691.90–$693.20 band remain in the "hit" column and have been cleared to the upside; no new active Carson level has reportedly been set since the reported April 14, 2026 major-resistance-zone hits. Per levels.json, the reported active support reportedly remains the sole open level in the file. Per data drop, the reported weekend tape reportedly left Friday's close as the operative read, with crypto consolidation and a reported Mideast risk premium reportedly carrying the principal weekend signal rather than any reported price action in Carson's reference instruments. For FCI positioning, Carson's level reportedly frames a deployment reference rather than a trade signal — the FCI buy-and-hold tranche framework reportedly deploys 70% of reserves at approximately –25% from peak and the remainder at approximately –40%, with no trimming on either side. The reported week-ahead cadence — reported JPMorgan Tuesday, reported CPI Wednesday, reported ASML Wednesday, reported TSMC Thursday — reportedly carries the principal catalyst risk; the committee should read Carson's level as the reference for a reported sustained drawdown rather than any single-session move.

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